SaaS CRM — User Guide

Audience: Everyday users of the CRM — business owners, admins, and staff who log in and use the system day to day.

This guide walks through every part of the CRM in the order you'll typically use it. Some sections only apply if your business plan includes that feature — if you don't see a menu item mentioned here, ask your admin whether it needs to be turned on.

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1. Logging In & Your Dashboard

After logging in, you land on your **Dashboard** — a snapshot of what needs your attention today:

- **Quick Actions** at the top let you jump straight to adding a Lead, creating a Deal, creating a Task, or making a Quotation — plus, if your business has them turned on, shortcuts for New Service, Book Appointment, Log Time, and New Ticket.
- **Alert banners** appear when something needs action: subscriptions expiring soon, open support tickets, appointments today, running time-trackers, or low stock/pending purchase requests — each one is clickable and takes you straight to the relevant list.
- **Stat cards** show your Total Leads, Revenue This Month, Active Deals, and Tasks Completed, each with a real month-over-month trend arrow.
- Below that: a revenue chart, your deal pipeline by stage, recent leads, today's agenda (tasks + follow-ups), your real lead-source breakdown, and a recent activity feed.

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2. Managing Leads

Leads are potential customers who haven't been qualified/converted yet.

- **Add a Lead** manually, or let leads flow in automatically from connected sources (Facebook/Instagram Lead Ads, IndiaMART, JustDial, TradeIndia, Sulekha, or your website) — set these up under **Lead Sources**.
- Each lead has a **status** (New → Contacted → Qualified → Converted/Lost) you move it through as you work it.
- Log calls directly on a lead, assign it to a teammate, or select several and **bulk-assign / bulk-update status / bulk-delete**.
- When a lead is ready, **Convert** it — this creates a matching Contact (and optionally a Deal) so you don't re-type anything.

- The system checks for **duplicates** automatically and lets you merge them if the same person came in twice.
- Import a spreadsheet of leads, or export your list, from the Leads page.

3. Contacts

Contacts are the people and companies you actually do business with (post-conversion, or entered directly). You can attach files, record multiple employees under one company contact, search customers quickly, and pull a per-customer report of everything they've bought or been quoted.

4. Deals (Sales Pipeline)

Deals track an active sales opportunity through stages (e.g. New → Proposal → Negotiation → Won/Lost). Drag a deal to a new stage, or use **Mark Won** / **Mark Lost** directly. The **Pipeline Analytics** view gives you a kanban/funnel picture of everything in flight and its total value.

5. Tasks, Follow-ups & Calendar

- **Tasks** support checklists, comments, file attachments, watchers (people who get updates without owning the task), and dependencies (task B can't start until task A is done). Save your own filtered views for quick access. Repeatable tasks can be created from a **Task Template** instead of from scratch each time.
- **Follow-ups** are simpler reminders to call/email/visit someone — mark them **Done** or **Missed** when the moment passes.
- The **Calendar** shows tasks, follow-ups, and appointments together in one view — drag an item to reschedule it, or quick-create a new one directly on a date.

6. Quotations & Invoices

- Create a **Quotation**, attach your standard terms (reusable **Terms Templates** save you retyping), and **Send** it by email or WhatsApp.
- Every quotation gets a shareable link where your customer can view it and **accept or reject it themselves — no login needed on their end**. You'll see the status update the moment they respond.
- Need to revise pricing after the fact? Create a **new version** rather than editing the original, so there's a clean history.
- Once accepted, **Convert to Invoice** in one click.

- On an **Invoice**, record payments (including partial payments across multiple installments), send it to the customer, and download/print a branded PDF (your logo/colors are configurable under Invoice PDF Settings).

7. Products & Purchasing

(Relevant if your business stocks or manufactures physical goods.)

- **Products** is your catalog — track current stock and a reorder level; the **Low Stock** view shows anything at or below that level so you know what to reorder.
- **Vendors** are your suppliers. When multiple vendors quote you a price for the same thing, use **Vendor Quotes** to compare and pick a winner before committing.
- The buying workflow: raise a **Purchase Request** → it gets **approved** (or rejected with a reason) → becomes a **Purchase Order** sent to your chosen vendor → when goods arrive, **Receive** the order, which automatically updates your stock and can create a tracked **Batch/Lot** for that shipment.
- If you manufacture rather than just resell, **Work Orders** track a production job against a product: start it, complete it (this consumes the raw materials and adds the finished good to stock), or cancel it — with labor/machine/material costs tracked per order.

8. Services, Subscriptions, Appointments, Time Tracking & Tickets

(Relevant if your business is service-based — gyms, IT support/AMC, coaching institutes, salons, consultancies, and similar.)

Service Catalog

List every service you offer with its price, billing cycle (one-time/monthly/etc.), and duration. You can also bundle several services into a **Package** that behaves like one service everywhere else in the system (invoicing, subscriptions, reminders).

Subscriptions

Track which customer has which active service and when it expires. Turn on **Customer Reminders** (Email and/or WhatsApp) to automatically message the customer before their subscription lapses — you can customize exactly what the message says, preview it live, and send yourself a test before turning it on. You can also send a reminder manually at any time, renew or cancel subscriptions individually or in bulk, and review a full history of every reminder ever sent.

Appointments / Online Booking

Turn this on and you get a **public booking link** you can share anywhere (WhatsApp, Instagram bio, website) — customers pick a service and an available time slot and book themselves in, no account needed. Configure your business hours, slot length, and how many bookings you can take per slot under **Booking Settings**. The system automatically reminds the customer a day before their appointment, and if a booking is never marked complete or cancelled a couple of hours after it ended, it's automatically flagged as a **no-show** so your records stay accurate without extra effort.

Time Tracking

Start a timer when you begin working on something for a customer, stop it when you're done (or enter time manually). Mark entries as billable or not, and when you're ready to bill, select a batch of billable entries and **Convert to Invoice** in one step.

Tickets / Helpdesk

Customers can submit a support request through your **public support link**, or your team can log one on their behalf. Every ticket gets a **ticket number** (like `TKT-20260822-0001`) the customer can quote if they call back, and they receive an automatic confirmation by Email and/or WhatsApp the moment it's created — you control which channel(s) that goes out on, and can customize the message, under the Tickets page's confirmation settings. Staff can reply (the customer is notified automatically), add **internal notes** that customers never see, attach files, set priority, and assign the ticket to a teammate. Overdue-to-respond tickets are automatically flagged for follow-up based on their priority.

9. Sending Email & WhatsApp

Under **Email** and **WhatsApp**, you can send one-off messages, do a bulk send to a filtered list, build reusable **Templates** (with live preview), and review a full log of everything sent. You can connect your **own email server (SMTP)** instead of the platform default if you prefer sending from your own domain. If enabled on your plan, the **WhatsApp Chatbot** lets you build automated conversation flows that respond to customers without a human involved, and **Instagram** automation can auto-reply to comments and DMs.

If your plan includes the **WhatsApp Team Inbox**, open **Messages → WA Inbox** to read and answer customer chats with your whole team from one number. Reply with text or a file, mark a chat resolved when it's done, and see unread chats at a glance. You can also **assign a chat** to a teammate (or switch on auto-assign to share new chats in turn), type **/** to insert a saved **quick reply**, and leave a **private note** that only your team sees. Owners get a **Team Performance** report (first-reply time per teammate) and a **Campaigns** page showing how every bulk send did; in **Bulk Send**

you can filter Leads by status and source before selecting everyone, and **schedule** a send for later (cancel it from Campaigns until it starts). If a customer replies **STOP** they are skipped in all bulk sends until they reply **START**, and a first message from a new number is saved as a **Lead** automatically. WhatsApp allows free replies only within 24 hours of the customer's last message — after that, send an approved template. Full steps: `docs/whatsapp-team-inbox.md`.

10. Reports

Under **Reports**, pick a date range and explore: Overview (top-line KPIs), Deals, Deal-to-Quotation conversion, Revenue, Staff performance, and — if those modules are on — Subscriptions, Appointments, Tickets, and Time Tracking, each with its own KPIs and breakdowns relevant to that area.

11. Team & HR

- **Staff** and **Departments** manage your team structure.
- **Attendance** lets staff clock in/out, or an admin can enter attendance manually or in bulk.
- **Roles & Permissions**: three roles come built in — an admin (full access), staff (a sensible day-to-day default), and superadmin (platform-level, not something you manage). If the default staff access doesn't match how you want to run things, create a **custom role** with exactly the permissions you want and assign it to whichever teammates need it.
- **Audit Logs** give admins a change history across the system — useful for "who changed this and when."

12. Notifications & Settings

The bell icon shows your in-app notifications; visit **Notification Preferences** to choose which alerts you get and on which channel. Under **Settings**, manage your company info/logo, custom fields (add your own fields to Leads, Contacts, Deals, etc. without any coding), and your own subscription/billing with this platform.

Tips

- Anything with a public link (Quotations, Booking, Support Tickets) is safe to share widely — the link only lets someone see/act on that one specific record or submit a new one, never your other data.
- If a feature mentioned here isn't visible in your menu, it's likely tied to your current plan or hasn't been switched on for your account yet — reach out to your admin or support to enable it.

- "AI Automation" in the sidebar is a request form, not a self-service builder — describe what you want automated and the platform team follows up to build it for you.